

HERNANDO, PANTINE B. CHALLENGE 3 - CRYPTOGRAPHY

BSIT-3

13

Easy

Cryptography

picoCTF 2019

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Description

Cryptography can be easy, do you know what ROT13 is?
cvpbPGS{abg_gbb_onq_bs_n_ceboyrz}

Hints ?

1

This can be solved online if you don't want to do it by hand!

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This challenge is a classic introductory cryptography problem from **picoCTF 2019**. It focuses on understanding and reversing a simple substitution cipher.

Description

The challenge provides a string of ciphertext and asks if you know what **ROT13** is:

`cvpbPGS{abg_gbb_onq_bs_n_ceboyrz}`

The hint suggests that the challenge can be solved using online tools if the user prefers not to decode it manually.

Solution Strategy

The cipher used is **ROT13** ("rotate by 13 places"), a special case of the Caesar cipher. Since the English alphabet has 26 letters, shifting a letter by 13 positions is its own inverse.

Steps to solve:

1. **Identify the Cipher:** The title and description explicitly mention ROT13.
2. **Decrypt the String:** You can manually shift each letter by 13 places or use an online tool like rot13.com.
3. **Mapping Example:**
 - c becomes p
 - v becomes i
 - p becomes c
 - b becomes o
 - ...and so on.

Final Result

After processing the ciphertext through a ROT13 decoder , the original plaintext is revealed:

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The screenshot shows a web browser window with the address bar displaying "rot13.com". The page title is "rot13.com" with a link "About ROT13". Below the header, there is a large text input field containing the ciphertext "cvpbPGS{abg_gbb_onq_bs_n_ceboyrz}". A downward arrow points from this field to a dropdown menu labeled "ROT13". Another downward arrow points from the dropdown menu to a second text input field containing the decrypted plaintext "picoCTF{not_too_bad_of_a_problem}".